NIKHIL BHENSDADIA

Equity Research Analyst | CFA Level III Cleared
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Equity research analyst with buy-side experience at a hedge fund (stock selection, portfolio risk, options hedging) and sell-side experience writing market notes. Has written bottom-up fundamental research on 9 listed Indian companies, each with a buy/avoid call, conviction level and entry price.

EDUCATION

CFA Institute — CFA Program, passed Level I, II and III — Feb 2026

GSFC University, Vadodara — Bachelor's in Finance & Accounting, CGPA 7.66/10 — 2023

EXPERIENCE

Young Turtle LLP (Hedge Fund) — Ahmedabad
Research Analyst — *Jul 2025 – Present*

- Lead a 4-member research team; set daily priorities and review models and backtests before they go to PMs
- Compared 15+ stock selection frameworks (momentum, beta, idiosyncratic risk, low-volatility alpha, implied volatility) across bull, bear and sideways markets to find which one works in which phase
- Built a pair trading book (16% CAGR, CAR/MDD 5.0, worst month -4.1% over 17 years), now live with INR 6 Cr
- Approved 40+ index strategies for live trading and set the rules for shifting capital between them
- Wrote the fund's options hedging playbook (0.25-delta overnight protection, implied vs realised volatility triggers, roll timing, expiry selection), tested on Greeks rebuilt for the full option history
- Specified the logic for 3 in-house platforms with developers: order execution, an intraday options backtester, and a client presentation tool showing strategy track records and ideal capital allocation

Matalia Stock Broking Pvt. Ltd. — GIFT City, Gandhinagar
Equity Research Intern — *Sep 2024 – Nov 2024*

- Picked the firm's Diwali 2024 Muhurat portfolio (Avanti Feeds, Castrol India, Swaraj Engines, Skipper), which returned 11.1% over the next year against 6.8% for the NIFTY 50 and 4.2% for the BSE 500
- Wrote 60+ daily mid-day notes and 12+ weekly market reports for institutional and HNI clients on index trends, sector rotation and F&O positioning
- Tracked Q2 FY25 results against consensus, flagging margin trends, guidance changes and surprises

Kotak Securities — Equity Markets Intern, Vadodara — Dec 2022 – Jan 2023

Manoj Vipin & Co., Chartered Accountants — Audit & Tax Intern (stock audit, GST, ITR) — Jun 2022 – Jul 2022

INDEPENDENT EQUITY RESEARCH

Buy calls: HDFC Bank, Bharti Airtel, Mahindra & Mahindra (3-4 year horizon) — Oct 2026

- Screened 10 sectors on growth, earnings cycle, industry structure, valuation vs history and FII positioning; private banks, telecom and auto leaders ranked highest
- HDFC Bank at Rs 707, base value Rs 1,121 (59% upside, ~17% IRR): valued on justified P/B with bear/base/bull cases, and set exit tests on NIM, CASA and ROA for FY28
- M&M at Rs 2,889, base value Rs 4,498 (~16% IRR): argued the margin dip is commodity-driven while SUV and tractor demand holds, at 17.6x earnings vs ~31x for the auto sector

Avoid / wait calls: 5 small and mid caps, plus a holding company — Oct 2026

- Wrote initiation-style notes on MIC Electronics, Websol Energy, E2E Networks, Divgi TorqTransfer and Modi Naturals, rating each avoid with an entry level and using reverse DCF to show what the price assumes
- Used annual reports, earnings calls and rating reports to flag governance and business model risks: 375 receivable days and a promoter stake cut from 74.6% to 41.7% at MIC; a one-off order behind Divgi's growth
- Built a look-through NAV for Pilani Investment (Aditya Birla Group), showing a ~79% discount, and capped it at a small position because debt-funded group buying keeps the discount structural

Chambal Fertilisers: DCF & Peer Valuation — Jun 2024 – Jul 2024

- Built a 5-year FCFF DCF cross-checked with EV/EBITDA and P/E against fertiliser peers; thesis rested on urea pricing policy, agri-input demand and segment margins

SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

Research & Valuation: Financial statement analysis, financial modelling, earnings forecasting, DCF, reverse DCF, justified P/B, SOTP / NAV, relative valuation, scenario analysis, business model and competitive positioning, sector, macro and regulatory research

Portfolio & Risk: Portfolio construction, portfolio monitoring, capital allocation, position sizing, risk-reward and drawdown analysis, factor and market-regime analysis, options hedging, Greeks, implied vs realised volatility

Tools: Advanced Excel, Python (pandas, NumPy), ProwessIQ database, AmiBroker, Stockmock, Sensibull, ODIN

Certifications: NISM Series V-A (Mutual Fund Distributors), NISM Series VIII (Equity Derivatives)